KENYA INSTITUTE OF CURRICULUM DEVELOPMENT
A Skilled and Ethical Society

SENIOR SCHOOL CURRICULUM DESIGN

GRADE 10

GENERAL SCIENCE

2025

DRAFT

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FOREWORD

The Government of Kenya (GoK) is committed to ensuring that policy objectives for Education, Training and Research meet the aspirations of the Kenya Constitution 2010, the Kenya Vision 2030, National Curriculum Policy 2019, the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and the Regional and Global conventions to which Kenya is a signatory.

Towards achieving the mission of Basic Education, the Ministry of Education (MoE) embarked on a reform process that culminated in the adoption of a Competency Based Education (CBE) system in 2017. This came after extensive research, stakeholder engagement international benchmarking and consideration of the 21st Century socio-economic realities. CBE in Kenya adopted a 2-6-3-3 structure where the numbers indicate the years learners take at various levels in Basic Education (Pre-Primary, Primary, Junior School and Senior School; respectively). CBE has for critical elements: The Competency Based Curriculum (CBC), Pedagogy (teaching and learning), Resources and the Competency Based Assessment. The MoE oversees the provision of resources while the other components (Curriculum, Pedagogy and Assessment are handled by the Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development, (KICD), Teachers Service Commission, (TSC) and the Kenya National Examinations Council (KNEC); respectively.

KICD has successfully developed curriculum designs that have been used in the implementation of the Competency Based Curriculum (CBC) for the Pre-Primary, Primary and Juniors School levels. The first cohort of learners pursuing the CBC will transit to Senior School (Grades 10-12) in 2026. The curriculum designs at this level are expected to facilitate learners to acquire relevant knowledge, skills, values and attitudes (competencies) in preparation for tertiary education and the world of work. I urge all agencies of the GoK and other stakeholders in Education to use the designs to plan for effective and efficient implementation of Competency Based Education.

MR. JULIUS MIGOS OGAMBA
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PREFACE

The Ministry of Education (MoE) through the State Department for Basic Education, has been implementing the Competency Based Education (CBE) since the adoption of the *Basic Education Curriculum Framework* (KICD, 2017) during the national convention in January 2017. The Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development (KICD) developed Competency Based Curriculum (CBC) designs that were used for pilot studies in 2017 and 2018 before the roll-out at Pre-Primary and Primary Early Year (Grades 1 to 3 in 2019. The curriculum was then introduced in the subsequent grades through *a phase in –phase out* strategy, to ensure a smooth transition. Currently, the first cohort of CBC learners are at Grade 9 – the last grade at Junior School. The implementation of CBE has since benefited immensely from the recommendations of the *Presidential Working Party on Education Reforms* (PWPER) that were released in August, 2023 and fully implemented, in terms of curriculum designs.

Grade 10 is the entry class of the Senior School (SS) in Basic Education, a very critical level where learners shall have the opportunity to focus on pathways, tracks and subjects of their choices guided by the potentials demonstrated at earlier levels. The Senior School shall; therefore, form a foundation for further education and training and/or initial competencies for the Industry. This is an important step in the realisation of the Vision and Mission of the curriculum reforms as enshrined in the Sessional Paper No. I of 2019 whose title is: *Towards Realizing Quality, Relevant and Inclusive Education and Training for Sustainable Development* in Kenya.

The Grade 10 curriculum designs, like the designs for earlier levels, are anchored on the Kenyan National Goals of Education. They also present essence statements, general and specific expected learning outcomes as well as strands and sub strands for the learning areas. The designs also outline suggested learning experiences, key inquiry questions, core competencies, Pertinent and Contemporary Issues (PCIs), values and suggested assessment.

The Ministry of Education, through the State Department for Basic Education commits to provide resources and relevant guidelines for a smooth implementation of the CBC. It is expected that the designs will guide teachers to effectively facilitate learners to attain the expected learning outcomes for Grade 10 specifically and Senior School in general.

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

The Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development (KICD) Act Number 4 of 2013 (Revised 2019) mandates the Institute to develop curricula, programmes and curriculum support materials for Basic and Tertiary Education and Training. The curriculum development process involves research, international benchmarking and robust stakeholder engagement. Through a systematic and consultative process, the KICD conceptualised the Competency Based Curriculum (CBC) as captured in the *Basic Education Curriculum Framework* (KICD,2017), that responds to the demands of the 21st Century, the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). African Agenda 2063, East African Community Protocol and the aspirations captured in the Kenya Constitution 2010 and the Kenya Vision 2030.

KICD receives its funding from the GoK to enable the successful achievement of the stipulated mandate and implementation of the Government and Education sector plans. The Institute also receives support from development partners targeting specific programmes. The Grade 10 curriculum designs were developed with the support of the World Bank and GoK through the *Kenya Primary Education Equity in Learning Programme* (KPEELP); a project coordinated by the MoE. Therefore, the Institute is very grateful to the GoK, through the MoE and the development partners (especially The World Bank) for support in terms of policy guidance, resource provision and capacity building. Specifically, I wish to express special thanks to the Cabinet Secretary-MoE and the Principal Secretary-State Department for Basic Education.

We also wish to acknowledge the KICD curriculum development officers and other staff, all teachers, educators who took part as panellists; the institutions that participated and representatives of various stakeholders for their roles in the development of the Grade 10 curriculum designs. In relation to this, we acknowledge the support of the Chief Executive Officers of the Teachers Service Commission (TSC), the Kenya National Examinations Council (KNEC) and other agencies in the sector for their support in the process of developing these designs.

Finally, we are very grateful to the KICD Council Chairperson and other members of the Council for consistent guidance and oversight. We assure all teachers, parents and other stakeholders that these curriculum designs will effectively guide the implementation of the CBE at Grade 10 and preparation of learners for transition to further education and training or the world of work.

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

FOREWORD ii
PREFACE iii
ACKNOWLEDGEMENT iv
TABLE OF CONTENTS v
NATIONAL GOALS OF EDUCATION vi
THE SENIOR SCHOOL IN THE COMPETENCY BASED CURRICULUM viii
LEARNING OUTCOMES FOR SENIOR SCHOOL viii
LIST OF SUBJECTS AT SENIOR SCHOOL ix
LESSON DISTRIBUTION AT SENIOR SCHOOL x
ESSENCE STATEMENT xi
GENERAL LEARNING OUTCOMES xii
SUMMARY OF STRANDS AND SUB STRANDS xiii
STRAND 1.0: LIFE SCIENCE 1
STRAND 2.0: MATTER AND CHEMICAL REACTIONS 18
STRAND 3.0: NATURAL PHYSICAL SCIENCE 33
APPENDIX: LIST OF ASSESSMENT METHODS, LEARNING RESOURCES AND NON-FORMAL ACTIVITIES 44

NATIONAL GOALS OF EDUCATION

Education in Kenya should:

1. **Foster nationalism and patriotism and promote national unity.**
   Kenya's people belong to different communities, races and religions, but these differences need not divide them. They must be able to live and interact as Kenyans. It is a paramount duty of education to help young people acquire this sense of nationhood by resolving conflicts and promoting positive attitudes of mutual respect, which enable them to live together in harmony and foster patriotism in order to make a positive contribution to the life of the nation.
2. **Promote the social, economic, technological and industrial needs for national development.**
   Education should prepare the youth of the country to play an effective and productive role in the life of the nation.
   a) **Social Needs**
   Education in Kenya must prepare children for changes in attitudes and relationships which are necessary for the smooth progress of a rapidly developing modern economy. There is bound to be a silent social revolution in the wake of rapid modernisation. Education should assist our youth to adapt to this change.
   b) **Economic Needs**
   Education in Kenya should produce citizens with the skills, knowledge, expertise and personal qualities that are required to support a growing economy. Kenya is building a modern and independent economy which is in need of an adequate and relevant domestic workforce.
   c) **Technological and Industrial Needs**
   Education in Kenya should provide learners with the necessary skills and attitudes for industrial development. Kenya recognises the rapid industrial and technological changes taking place, especially in the developed world. We can only be part of this development if our education system is deliberately focused on the knowledge, skills and attitudes that will prepare our young people for these changing global trends.
3. **Promote individual development and self-fulfilment**
   Education should provide opportunities for the fullest development of individual talents and personality. It should help children to develop their potential interests and abilities. A vital aspect of individual development is the building of character.

4. **Promote sound moral and religious values.**
   Education should provide for the development of knowledge, skills and attitudes that will enhance the acquisition of sound moral values and help children to grow up into self-disciplined, self-reliant and integrated citizens.
5. **Promote social equity and responsibility.**
   Education should promote social equality and foster a sense of social responsibility within an education system which provides equal educational opportunities for all. It should give all children varied and challenging opportunities for collective activities and corporate social service irrespective of gender, ability or geographical environment.
6. **Promote respect for and development of Kenya's rich and varied cultures.**
   Education should instil in the youth of Kenya an understanding of past and present cultures and their valid place in contemporary society. Children should be able to blend the best of traditional values with the changing requirements that must follow rapid development in order to build a stable and modern society.
7. **Promote international consciousness and foster positive attitudes towards other nations.**
   Kenya is part of the international community. It is part of the complicated and interdependent network of peoples and nations. Education should therefore lead the youth of the country to accept membership of this international community with all the obligations and responsibilities, rights and benefits that this membership entails.
8. **Promote positive attitudes towards good health and environmental protection.**
   Education should inculcate in young people the value of good health in order for them to avoid indulging in activities that will lead to physical or mental ill health. It should foster positive attitudes towards environmental development and conservation. It should lead the youth of Kenya to appreciate the need for a healthy environment.

THE SENIOR SCHOOL IN THE COMPETENCY BASED CURRICULUM

Senior School is the fourth level of Basic Education in the Competency Based Curriculum (CBC) that learners shall proceed to after the Pre-Primary School, Primary School and Junior School levels. The essence of Senior School is to offer learners a pre-tertiary/university/ pre-career experience in which the learners have an opportunity to choose pathways, tracks and subjects where they shall have demonstrated interest and/or potential at the earlier levels. Senior School comprises three years of education for learners generally in the 16-18 years age bracket and lays the foundation for further education and training at the tertiary level and the world of work. In the CBC vision, learners exiting this level are expected to be ***engaged, empowered and ethical citizens*** ready to participate in the socio-economic development of the nation.

At this level, learners shall take seven (7) learning areas as recommended by the *Presidential Working Party on Educational Reforms* (PWPER, 2023). These shall comprise **four compulsory learning areas** namely: English, Kiswahili, Essential Mathematics/Core Mathematics and Community Service Learning (CSL). Learners will choose between Core Mathematics (for learners pursuing the Science Technology Engineering and Mathematics Pathway) and Essential Mathematics (for learners pursuing the non-STEM pathways). The learner will select three learning areas depending on their career choice, aptitude, interest and personality with guidance by the career teacher at Senior School.

LEARNING OUTCOMES FOR SENIOR SCHOOL

By the end of Senior School, the learner should be able to: